Based on The Art of War (But these tactics can be used for planning or relationships)

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1. Strategic Foundation – Before You Act

Core Idea: Winning starts before conflict begins.

- War is governed by five factors:
    - Moral influence (alignment of people)
    - Weather (timing, cycles)
    - Terrain (environment)
    - Command (leadership quality)
    - Discipline (structure, execution)

Key Principle:
If you understand both yourself and your opponent, you will not be endangered.

Takeaway:
Preparation and clarity beat brute force.

Your Notes:

Moral law – align people with the ruler – ex – Churchill the battle of Britain –

Heaven (Weather) – night and day, cold and hot, timing and seasons – some people do better in the summer (Kayak and Biking)

Earth (Terrain) distances great and small, danger and security, geographic factors.

The commander – Wisdom, Sincerity, Benevolence, courage and strictness, must be "followable"

Discipline (or the Method) – Marshalling Army – each should know what they are meant to do.

Its OK to adjust campaigns - the most adept at this will win the battle (Genghis Khan was an expert at this)

All warfare is based on deception (Trojan Horse)

When using our forces, we must be perceived as inactive

Hold out or bait the enemy. Feign disorder and crush him – appear to run away and then crush him.

When you appear to run away, traps can be laid.

If he is secure at all points be prepared. If he is superior evade him. Deception is vital if you are weak.

If he is taking his ease, give him no rest. If his forces are united, separate them. (Divide and Conquer)

Attach where he is not prepared, appear where you are not expected.

These military devices – leading to victory, must not be divulged before hand.

The general who WINS the battle makes many calculations before the battle is fought. The general who LOSES the battle makes but a few calculations beforehand - - But (The Schlieffen Plan) no battle plan survives contact with the enemy – Eisenhower – plans are nothing but planning is everything.

2. Winning Without Fighting

Core Idea: The highest skill is to win without battle.

- Best: break enemy resistance without fighting
- Next: disrupt alliances
- Next: attack strategy
- Worst: attack fortified positions

Key Principle:
Avoid direct conflict when a smarter path exists.

Takeaway:
Efficiency > effort. Influence > force.

Your Notes:

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When you engage in actual fighting, if victory is long in coming, then men's weapons will grow dull and their ardor will be dampened. If you lay siege you will exhaust your strength (1779 siege of Gibraltar)

War should be short and sharp.

If the campaign is protracted, then the resources of the state will not be equal to the strain

Now when your weapons are dulled, and auror dampened, strength exhausted and treasure spent – other chieftains will spring up to take advantage of your extremity – then no man – however wise – will be able to avert the consequences of war.

We have heard of stupid haste in war, but cleverness has never been associated with long delays; Fabius (Fabian strategies – scorchted earth)

There is no instance of a country ever having neneftted from a long war

It is only one who is thoroughly acquiainted with the evils of war that can througholy understand – (30 years war – 8 million dead – most states were bankrupt (1618 to 1648))

Beware of those who fight for themselves and not the state.

The skillful soldier does not raise a second levy – neither are his supply wagons loaded more than twice – Julius Ceasar – quick tempo- quick attack – veni vidi vici

Bring war material from home but forage from the enemy – thus the army will have its needs.

The people must be aroused to anger – minister of info – anger and hatred trump fear.

The captured soldiers should be kindly treated – could be allys later. The conquered could fight alongside

In war, your object must be victory

3. Strategic Positioning (Shi)

Core Idea: Set conditions so victory is inevitable.

- Create advantage before engagement
- Use positioning, not reaction
- Let opponents defeat themselves

Key Principle:
Victory comes from setup, not struggle.

Takeaway:
Control the environment, not just actions.

Your Notes:

In the practical art of war, take the country whole and take the army whole. Attack the enemy's weakness and take the country whole.

Supreme excellence consists of breaking the enemies will without fighting

Siege – the General who is unable to control his temper will launch expensive assaults

A skillful leader subdues the enemies' troops without fighting. He captures cities without laying siege

Attack by stratagem – Casual chat – "Armistice Signed"

The general is the protective wall of the state:

*If the general is weak – the state is weak.

He will win who knows when to fight and when not to fight.

He will win who knows how to handle superior forces and inferior forces, and who adjusts his strategy accordingly.

He will win whose army is animated by the same spirit throughout the ranks (Churchill did this) clear and coherent

He will win who has prepared himself and waits for an unprepared enemy.

He will win who has military capacity and the Sovereign does not interfere with those in command.

Self-belief without self-knowledge is dangerous

Know your opponent!

If you know the enemy and know yourself : Don’t fear 100 battles

If you DON’T know the enemy but know your self: For every victory, you will suffer a defeat.

If you don’t know the enemy or yourself: You will succumb in every battle.

4. Energy & Momentum

Core Idea: Use force efficiently, like releasing a drawn bow.

- Combine direct and indirect tactics
- Build momentum before striking
- Use structure to amplify effort

Key Principle:
Controlled energy beats constant exertion.

Takeaway:
Timing + leverage = outsized results.

Your Notes:

TACTICAL DISPOSITIONS

The good fighters of old first put themselves beyond the possibility of defeat (Defense) then wait for an opportunity. (Example – rope a dope – Ali).

To secure ourselves against defeat lies in our own hands; but the opportunity of defeating the enemy is provided by the enemy (Feign defense)

Thus, a good fighter is able to secure himself against defeat, but cannot make certain of defeating the enemy (Churchill? Compromised with Hitler? No hang on them Hitler invades USSR and declares war on USA

Security against defeat implies defense tactics – ability to defeat the enemy means taking the offensive. To WIN you must be capable of ATTACK.

Defense equals insufficient strength but if you are going to attack, attack in and abundance of strength.

The general who is skilled in defense hides in the most secret recesses of the earth, he who is skilled in attack flashes forth from the topmost height of the heavens. Thus on one hand, we have the ability to protect ourselves, on the other, a victory which is complete.

To see victory when it is in the knowledge of the common herd is not the peak of excellence – be able to see the unseen. Succeed in tough times.

To see the sun and the moon is no sign of sharp sight. To hear thunder not a the sign of a quick ear. Steve Jobs coming back to Apple – what is not obvious – perceive.

What the ancients call a cleaver fighter is one who not only wins – but wins with ease – don't get into difficult fights – do it with skill – not effort.

He who wins battles does so by NOT making mistakes. Making no mistakes establishes the certainty of victory – for it means converging on an enemy that who is already defeated. (Hannibal)

Thus, it is in war that the victorious strategist only seeks battle AFTER the victory has been won – where one who is destined to defeat first fights and look for victory (Enigma with the nazi planners)

The consummate leader cultivates the moral law and strictly addresses the method and discipline – thus it is within his power to control success (Ex King Albert I of Belgium)

VICTORY:

VICTORY	**COMES FROM**	**THE BALANCE OF CHOICES**
THE BALANCE OF CHOICES	**COMES FROM**	**CALCULATIONS**
CALCULATIONS	**COMES FROM**	**ESTIMATION OF QUALITY**
ESTIMATION OF QUALITY	**COMES FROM**	**MEASUREMENT**
MEASUREMENT	**OWES ITS EXISTANCE TO**	**EARTH**

Preparations include the SUPPLY TRAIN and Others behavior

Use DATA, not OPINIONS – to CHOOSE

A victorious army, as opposed to a routed one, is like a pound's weight placed on the scale vs a single grain. (Americans LOVE a winner and will not tolerate a loser – work hard to build morale after failure)

The onrush of a conquering force is like the bursting pent up waters into a dam a thousand fathoms deep.

ENERGY

The control of large force is the same as the force of a few men; it is merely a question of dividing up their numbers – Add a 5* general

Fighting with a large number is not different than fighting with a small number, it is merely a question of instituting signs and signals – communicate – corps – hierarchies will manage communication network.

The impact of your army may be like a grindstone against an egg – this is affected by the science of weak points and strong

Indirect tactics, when efficiently applied, are as inexhaustible as heaven and earth, unending as the flow and streams of rivers, like the sun and moon – they begin and end anew, like the 4 seasons, they pass away to return once more.

There are more than 5 musical moves – or chess moves - >288 billion after 4 moves – combos, patterns and solutions.

Direct and indirect attacks give rise to an endless series of maneuvers – Jackson vs Hooker in Chancellorsville.

The D and I lead on to each other to create infinite possibilities (victory disease), who can exhaust the possibilities.

The onset of troops is like the rush of a torrent – which will even roll stores along its course – (William Wallace – rapid series)

The quality of decision is like the well-timed swoop of a falcon which enables it to destroy its victim. (Trafalgar – waited for close range)

Energy is linked to the bending of a crossbow – decision to the releasing of the trigger – YOU decide when to pull the trigger

Amid the turmoil and tumult of the battle, there may be seeming disorder and yet no real disorder at all, your army may be without head or tail, yet it will be proof against defeat – control within disorder – (Germany – blitz and the battle of the bulge)

Simulated disorder postulates (pattern, discipline, courage and strength) vs (disorder, fear and weakness)

Fear risks disorder – but you can be misled by simulated fear.

Thus, one who is skillful at keeping the enemy on the move, maintains deceitful appearances, according to which the enemy will act, he sacrifices something so that the enemy may snatch it.

By holding out baits, keep the enemy in march – then a body in wait of picked men – lies in wait.

The clever combatant looks to the effect of combined energy; and does not require too much from individuals – Hence his ability to pick our the right men and utilize combined energy (synergy)

5. Weakness vs Strength

Core Idea: Attack weakness, avoid strength.

- Appear weak when strong, strong when weak
- Force opponent into disadvantage
- Stay unpredictable

Key Principle:
Shape your opponent's perception.

Takeaway:
Do not meet strength head-on.

Your Notes:

Weak Points and Strong

Whoever is first in the field and awaits the coming of the enemy will be fresh for the fight, whoever is second in the field must hasten, and will arrive exhausted.

Therefore, the clever combatant imposes his will on the enemy, but does not allow the enemies to be imposed on him – (Chamberlain)

By holding out advantages to him he can cause the enemy to approach on his own accord by inflicting damage – he can make it impossible for the enemy to draw near – (Austerlitz Weak Napoleon)

If the enemy is taking his ease – you can harass him

If well supplied with food – you can starve him out

If quietly encamped – force him to move

Remove the enemies' comfort (U Boat)

An army may march through great distances without being distressed – be ready

You can be sure of succeeding in your attacks if you only attach places that are undefended. (Vikings attacked churches) – make sure you have no weak points

O divine art of subtility and secrecy, through you we learn to be invisible, inaudible and hold the enemies fate in our hand

If we wish to fight, the enemy can be forced into an engagement even though sheltered – you can attack some other place – his supply lines for instance

If we do NOT wish to fight – we can prevent the enemy from engaging (Look at 3rd army division on DDAY)

The spot where we intend to fight must not be known, for then the enemy will be able to prepare at many points – don't wonder what they do.

When the enemy strengthens one area, he is weakening another. Rear/front/left/rear. Defensive wars betray us. Guard against defensive blows.

Knowing the time and place of the battle allows us to concentrate from the greatest distance in order to fight (Waterloo)

Number of troops doesn't matter – even then victory can be achieved – Snow – obscured vision – 1700 Sweden vs Rus (then Poltava of course)

Carefully compare the opposing army with your own, so you can know where your strength is super abundant and deficient

Conceal your dispositions and you will be safe from prying eyes.

All men can see the tactics I use to but none can see the strategy from which victoru has evolved.

Do not repeat the same tactics for the next battle

So, in war – avoid striking what is strong – strike what is weak

Be like water in shape

He could can modify his tactics with an opponent during battle, and succeed, is called a heaven born captain.

Ch 7 Maneuverability

In war, the general receives commands from the sovereign

Tactical maneuvering is turning the devious to direct, the misfortune into gain

Being able to entice the enemy into getting out of their pattern shows knowledge of the artifice of deviation.

Maneuvering with an army is advantageous but with an undisciplined multitude dangerous

Pros and cons with flying columns vs fully quipped armies n)

Make sure you know the capabilities of your men – forced march for 3 days will result in defeat (Unless you are Patton) – the strong men will get there first but there will only be 10 pct of them.

Don't forget your baggage trains or supplies – 50 li / 50% will make, 30 Li 66%

Don't enter into alliances unless you know the intentions of your allies

We cant lead the army if we don't know the terrain. Make sure you

Practice dissimulation and you will succeed. Conceal your feelings and intentions to the enemy

Let your rapidity be that of the wind; your compactness be that of the forest, raid and plunder like a fire – be immovable like a mountain – let your plans be dark as night – when you move, fall like a thunderbolt.

Deliberate before you make a move

Share your plunder and land with your soldiers

Use gongs drums banners and flags in the heat of battle

Be mindful

Start early in the morning – soldiers and people work better that way – don't keep them up late – and consider attacking when THEY are tired

Be disciplined, be calm - be to the goal and wait at ease while they struggle to get there – husband your strenth

Don't chooset battle when the enemy is looking calm and confident

Keep the high ground – avoid low

Don't swallow the bait – don't pursue an enemy that simulates flight

When you surround - leave an outlet free. Dont press a desparate foeon

Ch 8 variation of tactics

Do not encamp in difficult country – Do not linger in dangerously isolated positions. Better to be at a cross road with Allies

8:3 There are road which must not be followed, armies which must not be attacked, towns which must not be besieged, positions which must be defended and commands of the sovereign which must not be obeyed.

The more tactics a general knows, the better for his troops

A wise leader knows more than the student about the 5 advantages and will use them better.

Sieze advantage even if you are in a difficult spot, and you may extract yourself from misfortune

We need to focus more on being ready for the enemys attack than hoping they wont attack.

FIVE SINS OF A GENERAL

- **Recklesness**
- **Cowardice**
- **A hasty temper**
- **A delicacy of honor – which is sensitive to shame**
- **Over solicitude for his men. (Excessive concern)**

When there is a defeat – mediate on this post mortum

CH 9 ARMY ON THE MARCH

Pass quickly over mountains and stay in the valleys- camp in high places facing the sun – after crossing a river get far away from it.

Attack an army when a portion is across a river stream

Do not move up stream to meet the enemy

Get over marshes without delay – have water and grass near you with your back to trees

Camp on hard ground – no disease – this will spell victory

Occupy the sunny side of a hill with a slope to your right rear.

Don't cross a rainy rushy river

Avoid bad terrain – precipitous cliffs – hollows – confined places = thickets quiagmires and crevasses – we should let the enemy have these at his rear.

Check your surroundings – especially those where spies can hide

If the enemy provokes battle he is prepared. If its too good to be true it is.

The enemy may be moving around to make us suspicious may not be the true attack

Watch out for the rising of birds or scared animals

Peace proposals unaccompanied by a sword covenant indicate a plot

When soldiers are leaning they are faint from want to food, if those who are are sent to draw water drink it first the army is thirsty, if the enemy wont take advantage of gains he is exhausted. If birds gather – there are no people.

When an army feeds its horses grain and feeds the soldiers cattle and when they do not hang theirt cooking pots over the camp fires – they are getting ready to fight to the death.

If the enemies troops are making noise without attacking or retreating be careful – if too many of the enemy , wait and concentrate your forces.

Soldiers must be treated humaely but with Iron discipline.

Orders must always be obeyed.

Chapter 10 –

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6. Adaptability

Core Idea: Be fluid like water.

- No fixed strategies
- Adjust to conditions continuously

- Exploit change

Key Principle:
Rigidity leads to defeat.

Takeaway:
Flexibility is a competitive advantage.

Your Notes:

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7. Deception

Core Idea: All warfare is based on deception.

- Mislead about intentions
- Create false signals
- Manipulate expectations

Key Principle:
Confusion weakens the opponent.

Takeaway:
Perception often matters more than reality.

Your Notes:

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8. Timing & Speed

Core Idea: Move fast when opportunity appears.

- Be quick, but not rushed
- Strike when opponent is unprepared
- Avoid prolonged conflict

Key Principle:
Speed creates advantage.

Takeaway:
Delay benefits the opponent.

Your Notes:

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9. Intelligence & Information

Core Idea: Knowledge is power.

- Use spies and information networks
- Understand intentions and capabilities
- Reduce uncertainty

Key Principle:
Decisions improve with better information.

Takeaway:
Invest in insight before action.

Your Notes:

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10. Leadership

Core Idea: The leader determines success or failure.

- Calm under pressure
- Clear communication
- Discipline without cruelty
- Trust from followers

Key Principle:
Strong leadership creates unity.

Takeaway:
People follow confidence and clarity.

Your Notes:

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11. Managing Conflict Duration

Core Idea: Long conflicts are costly and dangerous.

- Avoid drawn-out struggles
- Resources and morale degrade over time
- Seek decisive outcomes

Key Principle:
Quick resolution preserves strength.

Takeaway:
End things efficiently.

Your Notes:

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12. Terrain & Environment

Core Idea: Use surroundings to your advantage.

- Different terrains require different tactics
- Positioning determines outcomes
- Avoid disadvantageous ground

Key Principle:
Environment shapes strategy.

Takeaway:
Location matters as much as action.

Your Notes:

AOW Ch 11 Terrain

Sun Tzu said: We may distinguish six kinds of terrain, to wit:

(1) Accessible ground;
   a. **Ground which can be freely traversed by both sides is called ACCESSIBLE.**
   b. **With regard to ground of this nature, be before the enemy in occupying the raised and sunny spots, and carefully guard your line of supplies. Then you will be able to fight with advantage.**

(2) entangling ground
   a. **From a position of this sort, if the enemy is unprepared, you may sally forth and defeat him. But if the enemy is prepared for your coming, and you fail to defeat him, then, return being impossible, disaster will ensue.**

(3) temporizing ground;[Ground which allows you to "stave off" or "delay."]
   a. **When the position is such that neither side will gain by making the first move, it is called TEMPORIZING ground.**
   b. **In a position of this sort, even though the enemy should offer us an attractive SITE, it will be advisable not to stir forth, but rather to retreat, thus enticing the enemy in his turn; then, when part of his army has come out, we may deliver our attack with advantage.**

(4) narrow passes;
   a. **With regard to NARROW PASSES, if you can occupy them first, let them be strongly garrisoned and await the advent of the enemy.**
   b. **Should the army forestall you in occupying a pass, do not go after him if the pass is fully garrisoned, but only if it is weakly garrisoned.**

(5) precipitous heights;
   a. **With regard to PRECIPITOUS HEIGHTS, if you are before hand with your adversary, you should occupy the raised and sunny spots, and there wait for him to come up.**

b. If the enemy has occupied them before you, do not follow him, but retreat and try to entice him away.

(6) positions at a great distance from the enemy.

a. If you are situated at a great distance from the enemy, and the strength of the two armies is equal, it is not easy to provoke a battle,and fighting will be to your disadvantage.

These six are the principles connected with Earth. The general who has attained a responsible post must be careful to study them.

Now, an army is exposed to six several calamities, not arising from natural

causes, but from faults for which the general is responsible. These are:

(1) Flight;

a. Other conditions being equal, if one force is hurled against another ten times its size, the result will be the FLIGHT of the former.

(2) insubordination;

a. When the common soldiers are too strong and their officers too weak, the result is INSUBORDINATION.

(3) collapse;

a. When the officers are too strong and the common soldiers too weak, the result is COLLAPSE.

(4) ruin

a) When the higher officers are angry and insubordinate, and on meeting the enemy give battle on their own account from a feeling of resentment, before the commander-in-chief can tell whether or no he is in a position to fight, the result is RUIN.

(4) disorganization ;

a) When the general is weak and without authority; when his orders are not clear and distinct; when there are no fixed duties assigned to officers and men, and the ranks are formed in a slovenly haphazard manner, the result is utter DISORGANIZATION.

(6) rout.

When a general, unable to estimate the enemy's strength, allows an inferior force to engage a larger one, or hurls a weak detachment against a powerful one, and neglects to place picked soldiers in the front rank, the result must be ROUT.

These are six ways of courting defeat, which must be carefully noted by

the general who has attained a responsible post.

The natural formation of the country is the soldier's best ally; but a power of estimating the adversary, of controlling the forces of victory, and of shrewdly calculating difficulties, dangers and distances, constitutes the test of a great general.

He who knows these things, and in fighting puts his knowledge into practice, will win his battles. He who knows them not, nor practices them, will surely be defeated.

If fighting is sure to result in victory, then you must fight, even though the ruler forbid it; if fighting will not result in victory, then you must not fight even at the ruler's idding.

The general who advances without coveting fame and retreats without fearing disgrace, [It was Wellington, I think, who said that the hardest thing of all for a soldier is to retreat.] whose only thought is to protect his country and do good service for his sovereign, is the jewel of the kingdom.

Regard your soldiers as your children, and they will follow you into the deepest valleys; look upon them as your own beloved sons, and they will stand by you even unto death.

If, however, you are indulgent, but unable to make your authority felt; kind-hearted, but unable to enforce your commands; and incapable, moreover, of quelling disorder: then your soldiers must be likened to spoilt children; they are useless for any practical purpose.

If we know that our own men are in a condition to attack, but are unaware that the enemy is not open to attack, we have gone only halfway towards victory.

If we know that the enemy is open to attack, but are unaware that our own men are not in a condition to attack, we have gone only halfway towards victory.

If we know that the enemy is open to attack, and also know that our men are in a condition to attack, but are unaware that the nature of the ground makes fighting impracticable, we have still gone only halfway towards victory.

Hence the experienced soldier, once in motion, is never bewildered; once he has broken camp, he is never at a loss.

Hence the saying: If you know the enemy and know yourself, your victory will not stand in doubt; if you know Heaven and know Earth, you may make your victory complete.

13. Discipline & Organization

Core Idea: Structure enables execution.

- Clear roles and expectations
- Consistent enforcement
- Organized systems

Key Principle:
Chaos leads to defeat.

Takeaway:
Systems outperform improvisation.

Your Notes:

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14. The Ultimate Principle

Core Idea: Victory is achieved through superior thinking, not force.

- Plan deeply
- Act decisively
- Adapt constantly

Final Takeaway:
The best victories are invisible — they look inevitable.

Your Notes:

Optional Add-On Section (Your Style)

You might want to add:

Applications:

- Business:
- Relationships:
- Negotiation:
- Personal Discipline:

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Chapter 12

THENINESITUATIONS

Sun Tzu said: The art of war recognizes nine varieties of ground:

(1) Dispersive ground;

(2) facile ground;

(3) contentious ground;

(4) open ground;

(5) ground of intersecting highways;

(6) serious ground;

(7) difficult ground;

(8) hemmed-in ground;

(9) desperate ground.

When a chieftain is fighting in his own territory, it is dispersive ground.

When he has penetrated into hostile territory, but to no great distance, it is facile ground.

Ground the possession of which imports great advantage to either side, is contentious ground.

Ground on which each side has liberty of movement is open ground.

Ground which forms the key to three contiguous states,
so that he who occupies it first has most of the Empire at his command,
is a ground of intersecting highways.
When an army has penetrated into the heart of a hostile country, leaving a number of fortified cities in its rear, it is serious ground.

Mountain forests, [Or simply "forests."]
rugged steeps, marshes and fens–all country that is hard to traverse: this is difficult ground.

Ground which is reached through narrow gorges, and from which we can only retire by tortuous paths, so that a small number of the enemy would suffice to crush a large body of our men: this is hemmed in ground.
Ground on which we can only be saved from destruction by fighting without delay, is desperate ground.

On dispersive ground, therefore, fight not. On facile ground, halt not. On contentious ground, attack not.

On open ground, do not try to block the enemy's way.

On the ground of intersecting highways, join hands with your allies.

On serious ground, gather in plunder.

In difficult ground, keep steadily on the march.

On hemmed-in ground, resort to stratagem.

On desperate ground, fight.

Those who were called skillful leaders of old knew how to drive a wedge between the enemy's front and rear;

Rapidity is the essence of war:

This is the great principle in war. Even if he gets to know of our approach, he will have to levy his soldiers in such a hurry that they will not be fit to oppose us. Thus the full fruits of victory will be ours.

take advantage of the enemy's unreadiness, make your way by unexpected routes, and attack unguarded spots.

The following are the principles to be observed by an invading force: The further you penetrate into a country, the greater will be the solidarity of your troops, and thus the defenders will not prevail against you.

Make forays in fertile country in order to supply your army with food.

Carefully study the well-being of your men, and do not over tax them. Concentrate your energy and hoard your strength.

Keep your army continually on the move, and devise unfathomable plans.

Throw your soldiers into positions whence there is no escape, and they will prefer death to flight. If they will face death, there is nothing they may not achieve.

Officers and men alike will put forth their uttermost strength.

Soldiers when in desperate straits lose the sense of fear. If there is no place of refuge, they will stand firm. If they are in hostile country, they will show a stubborn front. If there is no help for it, they will fight hard. Thus, without waiting to be marshaled, without waiting to be asked, they will do your will; without restrictions, they will be faithful; without giving orders, they can be trusted.

Prohibit the taking of omens, and do away with superstitious doubts. Then, until death itself comes, no calamity need be feared.

If our soldiers are not overburdened with money, it is not because they have a distaste for riches; if their lives are not unduly long, it is not because they are disinclined to longevity.

On the day they are ordered out to battle, your soldiers may weep, (snivel), those sitting up bedewing their garments, and those lying down letting the tears run down their cheeks.

But let them once be brought to bay, and they will display the courage of a Chu or a Kuei.

The skillful tactician may be likened to the SHUAI-JAN. Now the SHUAI JAN is a snake that is found in the Ch‘ang mountains. Strike at its head, and you will be attacked by its tail; strike at its tail, and you will be attacked by its head; strike at its middle, and you will be attacked by head and tail both.

Hence it is not enough to put one’s trust in the tethering of horses, and the burying of chariot wheels in the ground The principle on which to manage an army is to set up one standard of courage which all must reach.

How to make the best of both strong and weak–that is a question involving the proper use of ground.

Thus the skillful general conducts his army just as though he were leading a single man, willy-nilly, by the hand. It is the business of a general to be quiet and thus ensure secrecy; upright and just, and thus maintain order. He must be able to mystify his officers and men by false reports and appearances,and thus keep them in total ignorance.

By altering his arrangements and changing his plans, By shifting his camp and taking circuitous routes, he prevents the enemy from anticipating his purpose.

At the critical moment, the leader of an army acts like one who has climbed up a height and then kicks away the ladder behind him. He carries his men deep into hostile territory before he shows his hand.

He burns his boats and breaks his cooking-pots; like a shepherd driving a flock of sheep, he drives his men this way and that, and nothing knows whither he is going.

To muster his host and bring it into danger:–this may be termed the business of the general.

The different measures suited to the nine varieties of ground; the expediency of aggressive or defensive tactics; and the fundamental laws of human nature: these are things that must most certainly be studied.

When invading hostile territory, the general principle is, that penetrating deeply brings cohesion; penetrating but a short way means dispersion. When you leave your own country behind, and take your army across neighborhood territory, you find yourself on critical ground.

When there are means of communication on all four sides, the ground is one of intersecting highways.

When you penetrate deeply into a country, it is serious ground. When you penetrate but a little way, it is facile ground.

When you have the enemy's strongholds on your rear, and narrow passes in front, it is hemmed-in ground. When there is no place of refuge at all, it is desperate ground.

Therefore, on dispersive ground, I would inspire my men with unity of purpose. On facile ground, I would see that there is close connection between all parts of my army.

On contentious ground, I would hurry up my rear.

On open ground, I would keep a vigilant eye on my defenses. On ground of intersecting highways, I would consolidate my alliances. On serious ground, I would try to ensure a continuous stream of supplies. On difficult ground, I would keep pushing on along the road. On hemmed-in ground, I would block any way of retreat.

For it is the soldier's disposition to offer an obstinate resistance when surrounded, to fight hard when he cannot help himself, and to obey promptly when he has fallen into anger.

We cannot enter into alliance with neighboring princes until we are acquainted with their designs. We are not fit to lead an army on the march unless we are familiar with the face of the country–its mountains and forests, its pitfalls and precipices, its marshes and swamps. We shall be unable to turn natural advantages to account unless we make use of local guides.

To be ignored of any one of the following four or five principles does not befit a warlike prince.

When a warlike prince attacks a powerful state, his generalship shows it self in preventing the concentration of the enemy's forces. He overawes his opponents, and their allies are prevented from joining against him.

Hence he does not strive to ally himself with all and sundry, nor does he foster the power of other states. He carries out his own secret designs, keeping his antagonists in awe.

Thus he is able to capture their cities and overthrow their kingdoms.

Bestow rewards without regard to rule,

issue orders without regard to previous arrangements; and you will be able to handle a whole army as though you had to do with but a single man. Confront your soldiers with the deed itself; never let them know your design.

When the outlook is bright, bring it before their eyes; but tell them nothing when the situation is gloomy. Place your army in deadly peril, and it will survive; plunge it into desperate straits, and it will come off in safety.

For it is precisely when a force has fallen into harm's way that is capable of striking a blow for victory. Success in warfare is gained by carefully accommodating ourselves to the enemy's purpose.

By persistently hanging on the enemy's flank, we shall succeed in the long run in killing the commander-in-chief. [Always a great point with the Chinese.] This is called ability to accomplish a thing by sheer cunning.

On the day that you take up your command, block the frontier passes, destroy the official tallies, and stop the passage of all emissaries.

Be stern in the council-chamber, so that you may control the situation.

If the enemy leaves a door open, you must rush in. Forestall your opponent by seizing what he holds dear, and subtly contrive to time his arrival on the ground.

Walk in the path defined by rule, and accommodate yourself to the enemy until you can fight a decisive battle.

At first, then, exhibit the coyness of a maiden, until the enemy gives you an opening; afterwards emulate the rapidity of a running hare, and it will be too late for the enemy to oppose you.

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Chapter 13

THEATTACKBYFIRE

Sun Tzu said: There are five ways of attacking with fire. The first is to burn soldiers in their camp; the second is to burn stores; the third is to burn baggage trains; the fourth is to burn arsenals and magazines; the fifth is to hurl dropping fire amongst the enemy.

In order to carry out an attack, we must have means available. the material for raising fire should always be kept in readiness. There is a proper season for making attacks with fire, and special days for starting a conflagration.

The proper season is when the weather is very dry; the special days are those when the moon is in the constellations of the Sieve, the Wall, the Wing or the Cross-bar;

for these four are all days of rising wind. In attacking with fire, one should be prepared to meet five possible developments:

(1) When fire breaks out inside to enemy's camp, respond at once with an attack from without.

(2) If there is an outbreak of fire, but the enemy's soldiers remain quiet, bide your time and do not attack.

(3) When the force of the flames has reached its height, follow it up with an attack, if that is practicable; if not, stay where you are.

(4) If it is possible to make an assault with fire from without, do not wait for it to break out within, but deliver your attack at a favorable moment. and put them to headlong flight

(5) When you start a fire, be to windward of it. Do not attack from the leeward.

A wind that rises in the daytime lasts long, but a night breeze soon falls.

In every army, the five developments connected with fire must be known, the movements of the stars calculated, and a watch kept for the proper days.

Hence those who use fire as an aid to the attack show intelligence; those who use water as an aid to the attack gain an accession of strength.

By means of water, an enemy may be intercepted, but not robbed of all his belongings.

Unhappy is the fate of one who tries to win his battles and succeed in his attacks without cultivating the spirit of enterprise; for the result is waste of time and general stagnation.

Move not unless you see an advantage; use not your troops unless there is something to be gained; fight not unless the position is critical.

No ruler should put troops into the field merely to gratify his own spleen; no general should fight a battle simply out of pique.

If it is to your advantage, make a forward move; if not, stay where you are.

Anger may in time change to gladness; vexation may be succeeded by content.

But a kingdom that has once been destroyed can never come again into being; nor can the dead ever be brought back to life.

Hence the enlightened ruler is heedful, and the good general full of caution. This is the way to keep a country at peace and an army intact.

Chapter 14

THEUSEOFSPIES

Sun Tzu said: Raising a host of a hundred thousand men and marching

them great distances entails heavy loss on the people and a drain on the

resources of the State. The daily expenditure will amount to a thousand

ounces of silver.

There will be commotion at home and abroad, and men will drop down exhausted on the highways.

Hostile armies may face each other for years, striving for the victory which is decided in a single day. This being so, to remain in ignorance of the enemy's condition simply because one grudges the outlay of a hundred ounces of silver in honors and emoluments, is the height of inhumanity.

One who acts thus is no leader of men, no present help to his sovereign, no master of victory.

Thus, what enables the wise sovereign and the good general to strike and conquer, and achieve things beyond the reach of ordinary men, is FORE KNOWLEDGE. Now this foreknowledge cannot be elicited from spirits; it cannot be obtained inductively from experience, nor by any deductive calculation.

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Knowledge of the enemy's dispositions can only be obtained from other men.

Hence the use of spies, of whom there are five classes:

(1) Local spies;

(2) inward spies;

(3) converted spies;

(4) doomed spies;

(5) surviving spies.

When these five kinds of spy are all at work, none can discover the secret

system. This is called "divine manipulation of the threads." It is the sovereign's most precious faculty.

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Having LOCAL SPIES means employing the services of the inhabitants of a district.

Having INWARD SPIES, making use of officials of the enemy.

Having CONVERTED SPIES, getting hold of the enemy's spies and using them for our own purposes.

Having DOOMED SPIES, doing certain things openly for purposes of deception, and allowing our spies to know of them and report them to the enemy.

SURVIVING SPIES, finally, are those who bring back news from the enemy's camp.

Hence it is that which none in the whole army are more intimate relations to be maintained than with spies.

None should be more liberally rewarded. In no other business should greater secrecy be preserved.

Spies cannot be usefully employed without a certain intuitive sagacity.

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They cannot be properly managed without benevolence and straightforwardness.

Without subtle ingenuity of mind, one cannot make certain of the truth of their reports.

If a secret piece of news is divulged by a spy before the time is ripe, he must be put to death together with the man to whom the secret was told.

Whether the object be to crush an army, to storm a city, or to assassinate an individual, it is always necessary to begin by finding out the names of the attendants, the aides-de- camp, and door-keepers and sentries of the general in command. Our spies must be commissioned to ascertain these.

The enemy's spies who have come to spy on us must be sought out, tempted with bribes, led away and comfortably housed. Thus they will become converted spies and available for our service.

It is through the information brought by the converted spy that we are able to acquire and employ local and inward spies.

It is owing to his information, again, that we can cause the doomed spy to carry false tidings to the enemy.

Lastly, it is by his information that the surviving spy can be used on appointed occasions. The end and aim of spying in all its five varieties is knowledge of the enemy; and this knowledge can only be derived, in the first instance, from the converted spy.

Hence it is essential that the converted spy be treated with the utmost liberality.

Hence it is only the enlightened ruler and the wise general who will use the highest intelligence of the army for purposes of spying and thereby they achieve great results.

Spies are a most important element in water, because on them depends an army's ability to move.